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# The emergency toilet when the sewer is down

1. **Stop flushing.** If officials say sewer lines are damaged, or drains back up, don't flush.
2. **Line it.** Line the toilet bowl or a 5-gallon bucket with two heavy-duty trash bags.
3. **Absorbent.** After each use add kitty litter, sawdust, dirt or shredded paper to absorb liquid and cut odor.
4. **Seal and store.** Tie bags shut and store in a lidded can outside, away from water sources, until pickup.
5. **Hand hygiene.** Hand sanitizer or soap and water right next to the toilet. Every time.
6. **Kit list.** 5-gallon bucket with lid, heavy-duty bags, absorbent, toilet paper, sanitizer, gloves.

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## Go deeper: Survival Prep: Essential Skills

View on Amazon: https://www.amazon.com/dp/B0DK7MPQ2K

**Sources:**

CDC: Emergency sanitation - https://www.cdc.gov/water-emergency/about/index.html
Ready.gov: Build a kit - https://www.ready.gov/kit

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